JOHN HERNDON

FLOTSAM & JETSAM

A percussion ensemble for flexible instrumentation



creativity in percussion™

Flotsam & Jetsam by John Herndon
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TSPCE21-016

Tapspace Order #145860. 1 copy(s) purchased by Kasper Dumoulin (kasper.dumoulin.2003@gmail.com) on March 15, 2025. NOT FOR RESALE.

PROGRAM NOTES

The phrase "flotsam and jetsam" comes from maritime jargon, referring to items lost or discarded from onboard a ship. Over time, the phrase has expanded in meaning to refer to any accumulation of odds and ends.

If you've got a handful of percussionists and some "odds and ends" lying around, then you are ready for *Flotsam & Jetsam*!

—John Herndon

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PLAYERS AND INSTRUMENTATION

This piece offers flexibility in both instrumentation and number of performers. It is recommended that the piece be performed on found percussion instruments like buckets, pails, trash cans, or bell plates (get creative!). However, traditional percussion instruments like snare drums, toms, woodblocks, or cowbells may be used. Whether you are using found or traditional instruments, they should be graduated so that Player 1 has the highest pitched instrument and Player 4 has the lowest pitched instrument.

Here are a few examples of the endless instrumentation possibilities:

Example 1:

Player 1: Brake drum
Player 2: Metal bucket
Player 3: Plastic bucket
Player 4: Large plastic trash can

Example 2:

Player 1: Mounted tambourine
Player 2: Castanets
Player 3: Woodblock
Player 4: Medium tom

Example 3:

Player 1: Hi-hat
Player 2: Snare drum
Player 3: Medium tom
Player 4: Bass drum

Additional players may be added to the four parts to accommodate ensembles of any size. Besides doubling every part, here are a few ways more players can be added for performance:

5 Players:

Player 1 (x 1)
Player 2 (x 1)
Player 3 (x 1)
Player 4 (x 2)

7 Players:

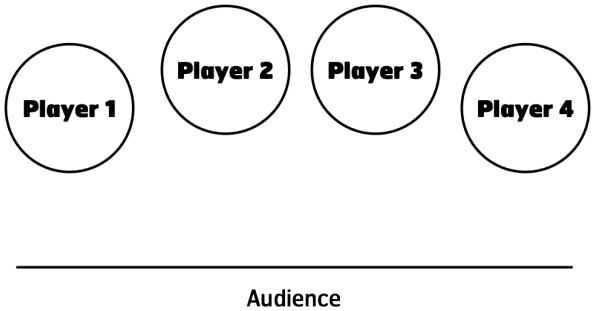
Player 1 (x 1)
Player 2 (x 2)
Player 3 (x 2)
Player 4 (x 2)

9 Players:

Player 1 (x 3)
Player 2 (x 2)
Player 3 (x 2)
Player 4 (x 2)

Finally, the piece may be performed on practice pads. In this scenario the pitch of the pads is not important. Just assign the parts by ability level, get drumming, and have fun!

SUGGESTED SETUP
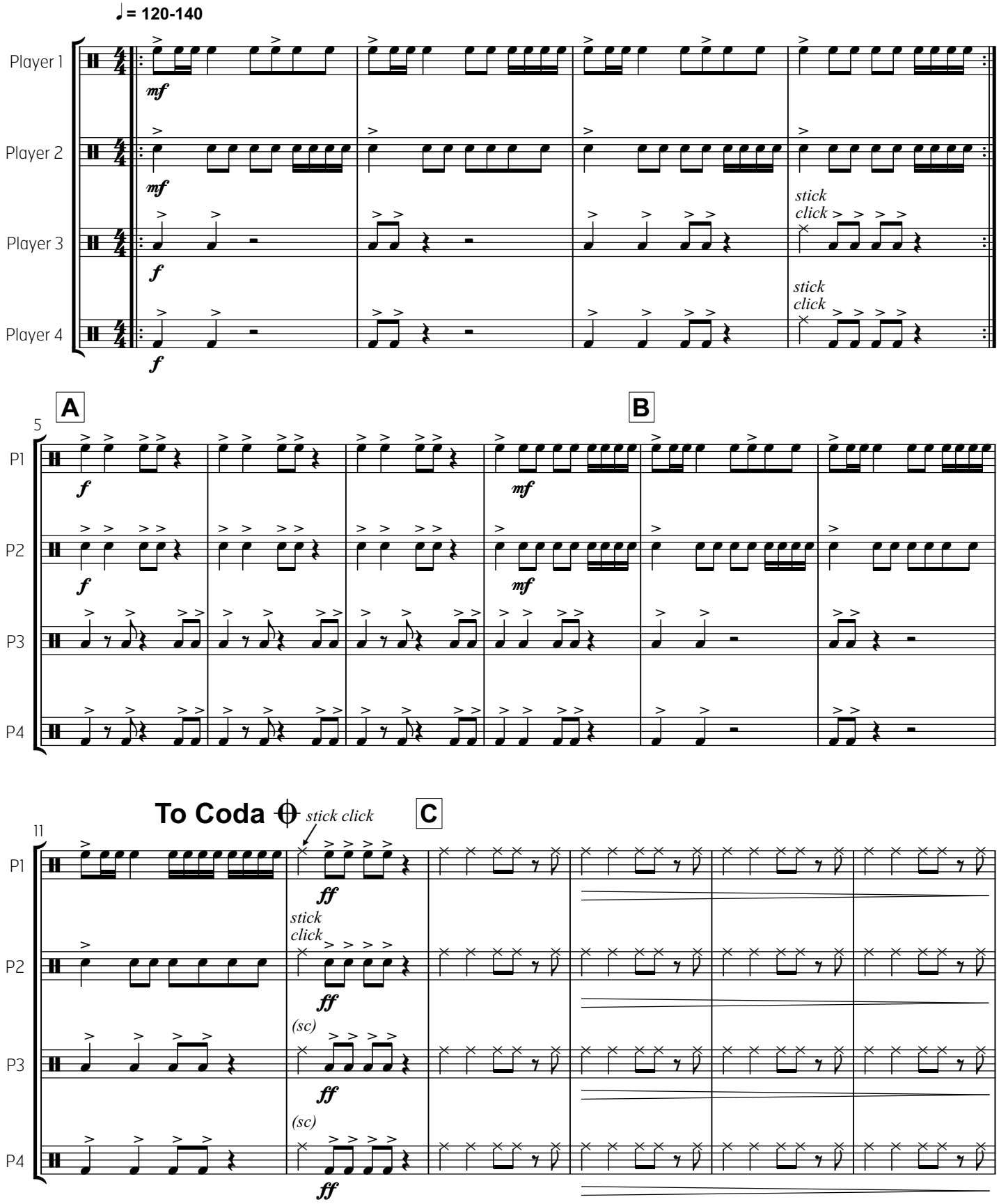


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Level: Easy
Approx. playing time: 2'20"

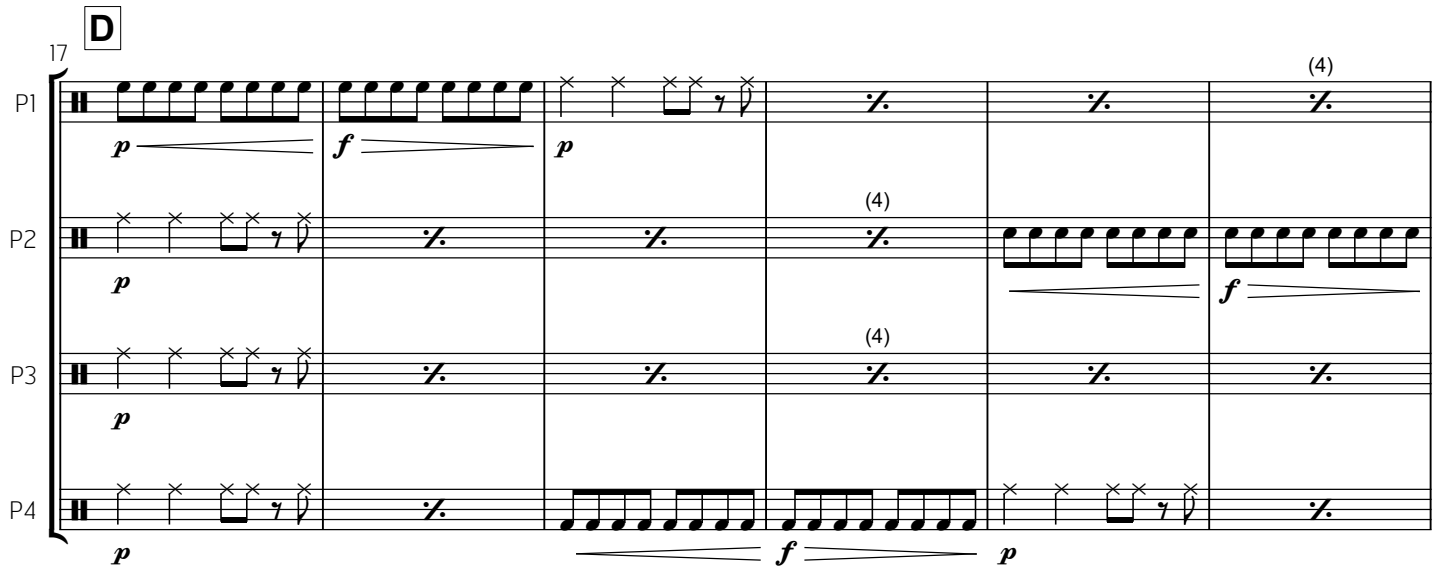
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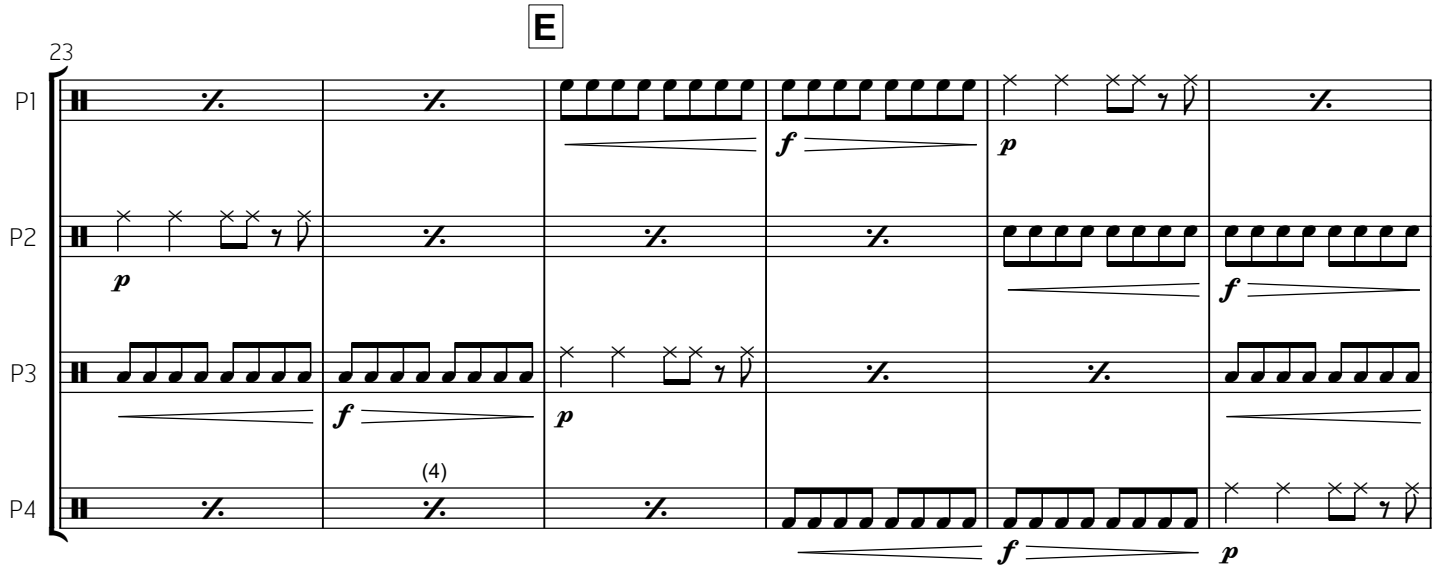
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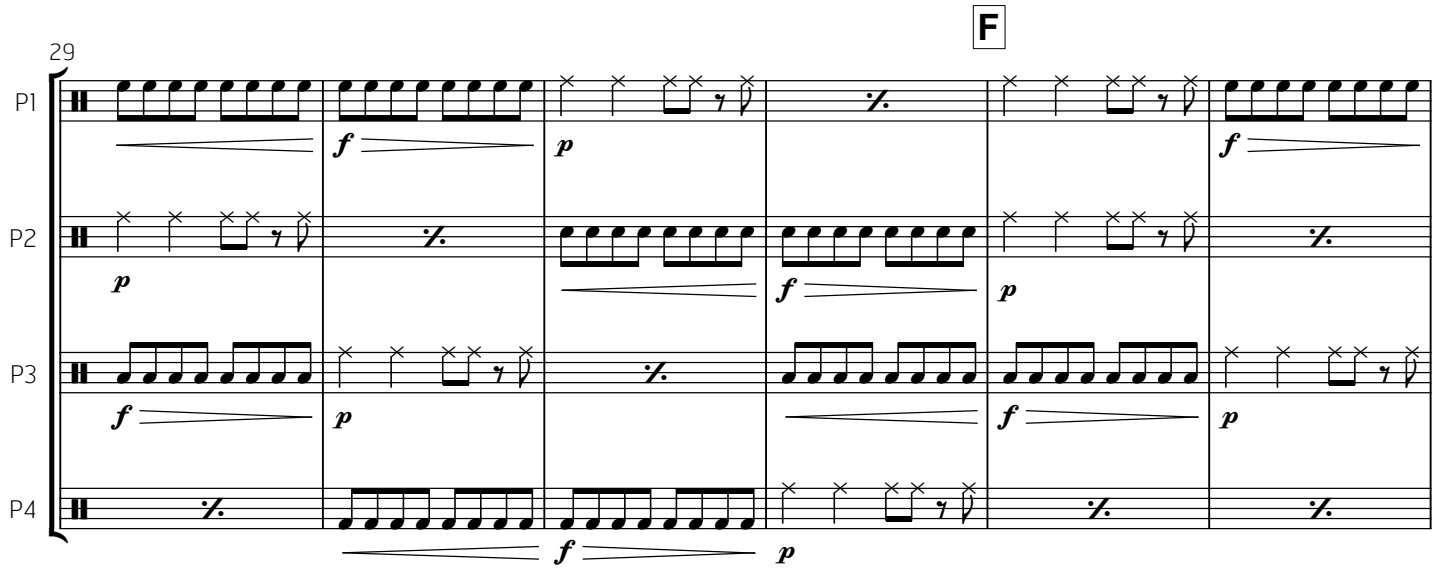


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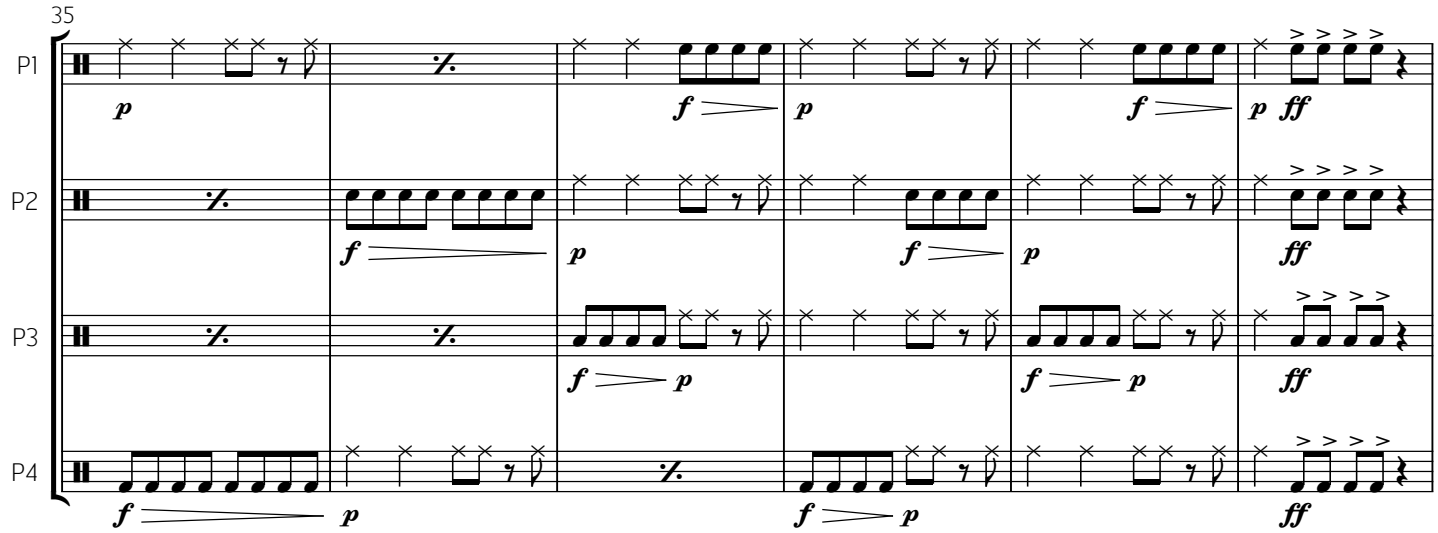
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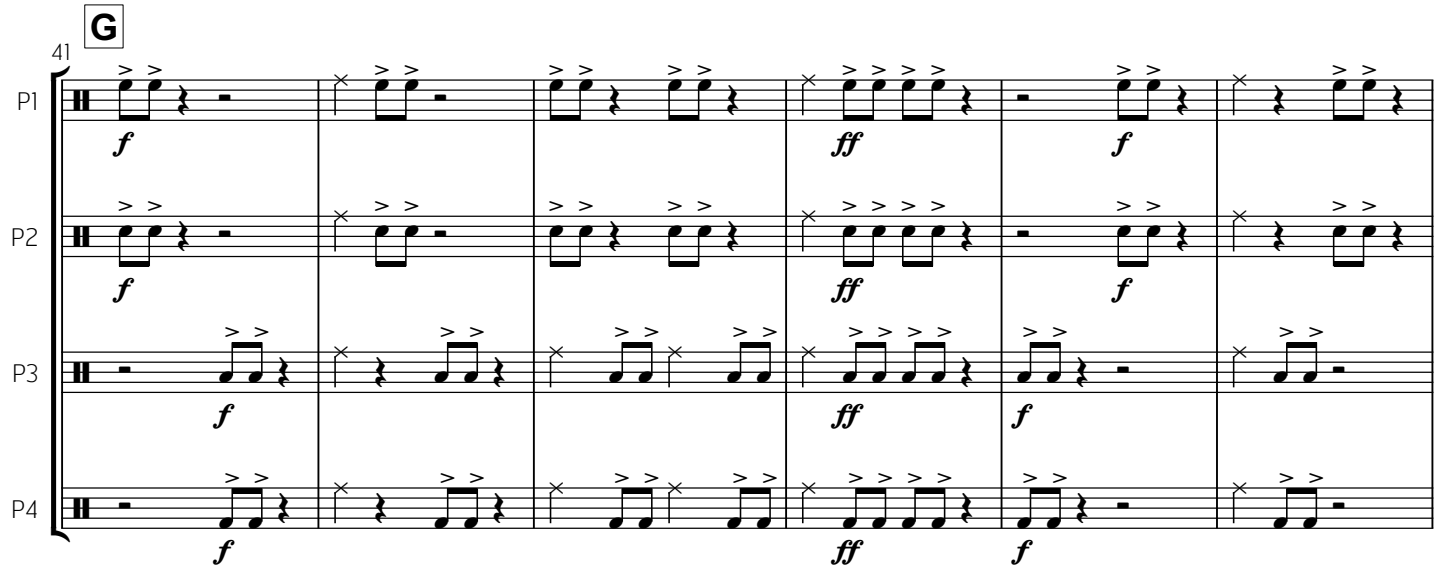


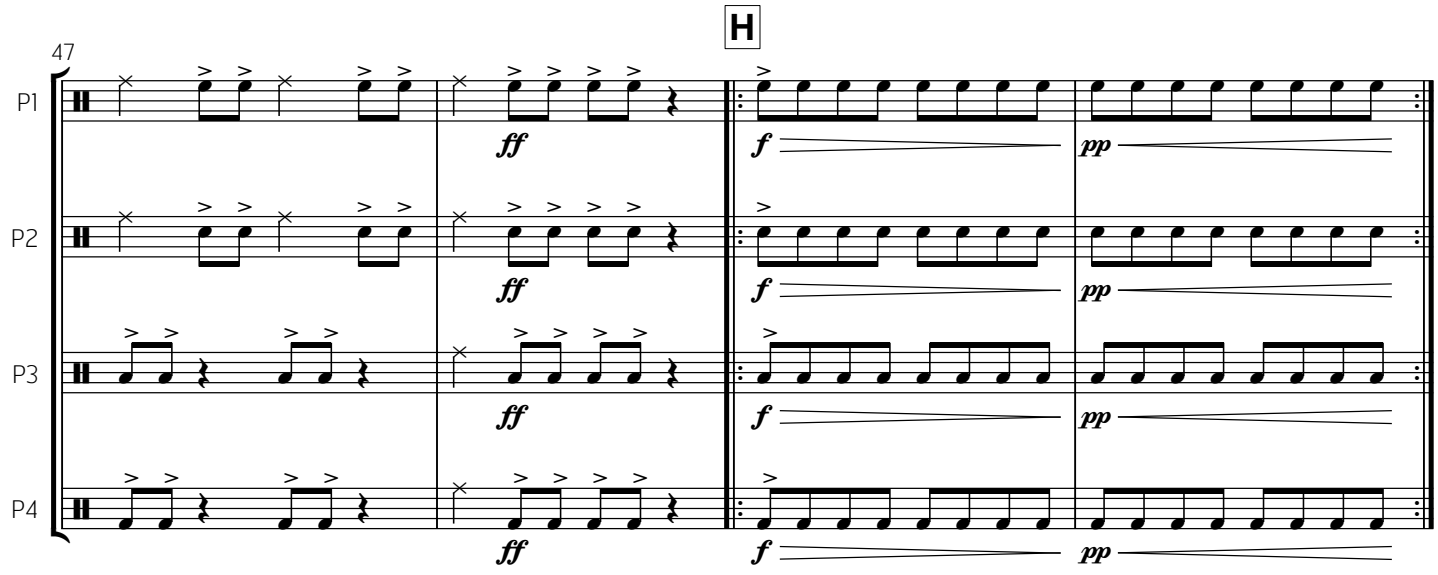




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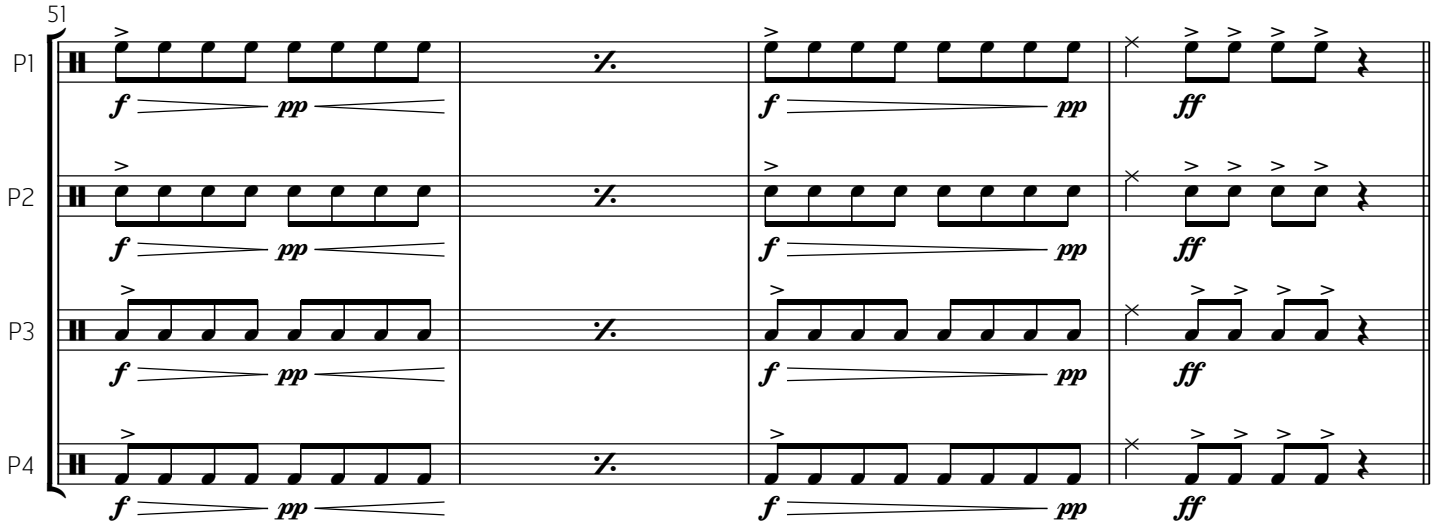




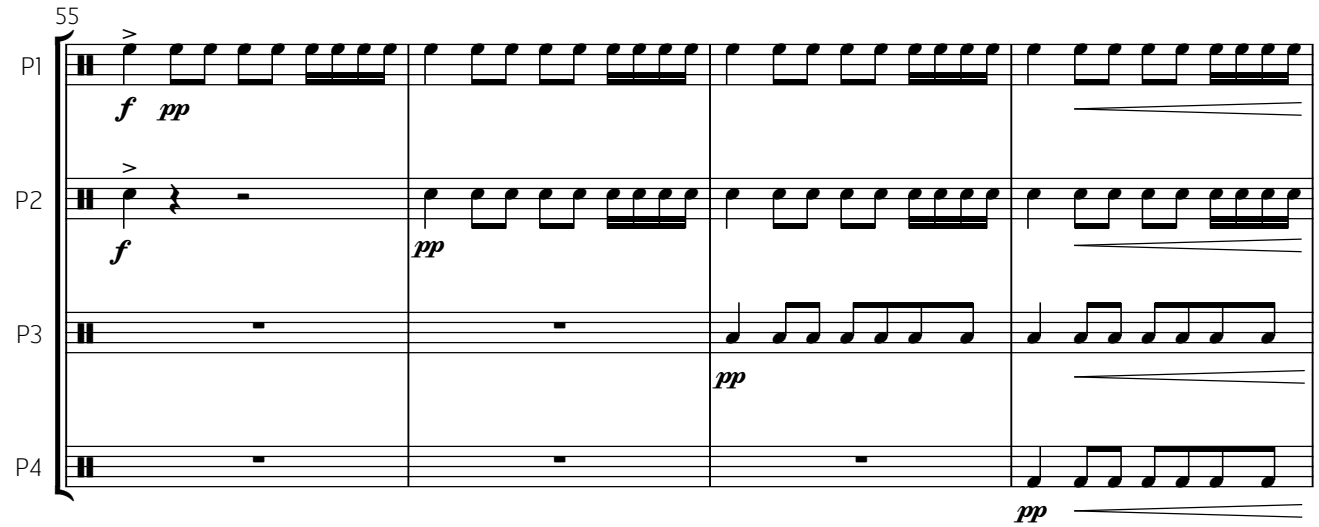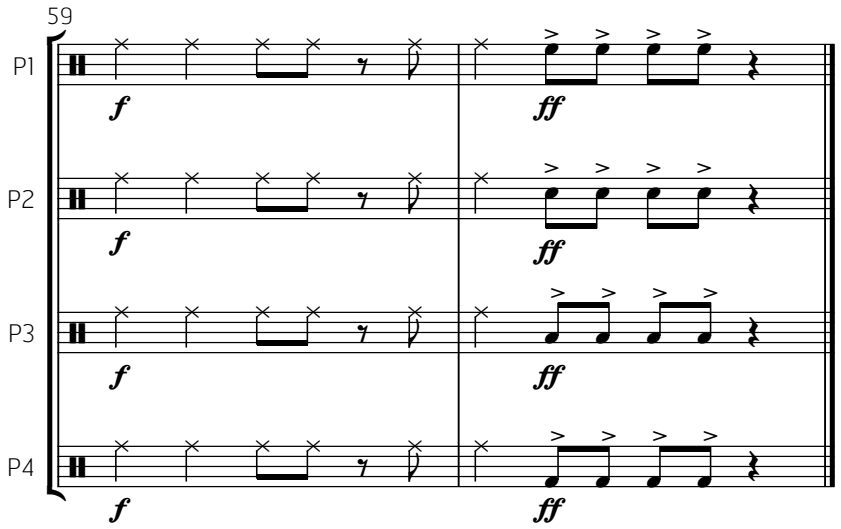


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D.C. al Coda



Coda





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